

Salvation

This lesson is first in the series entitled “**The Beginner’s Bible Study.**” Other lessons in this series can be obtained through the Lehigh Valley Baptist Church. Originally these lessons were given in sermon form, so please excuse the style of writing.

The lessons are designed to be first studied, then the questions in the back answered, and then reviewed with the help of an older Christian.

***“As ye have therefore received Christ Jesus
the Lord, so walk ye in Him.”***

Colossians 2:6

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We will begin this Bible study by talking about the most important subject you can ever talk about when you come to Scripture. That subject is the teaching of the Bible on salvation. Often when we come to the Word of God and think of salvation we say, “Oh, I’ve heard that before. I’m saved and that’s enough.”

I hope the material I present to you will be simple enough that you can understand it. Yet, when you come to the matter of salvation you need to remember that even though salvation is simple, salvation is also deep. Though you may have been saved for years and know the gospel inside and out, there are more depths than you and I can begin to imagine.

Trying to understand why Christ would die for us—apart from the fact the Bible says “*God so loved the world...*” (John 3:16)—is really difficult. Why would He love the world? Those that walk around with the attitude that they are worthy of salvation are those who are not saved.

In Luke 7 Jesus was telling a parable, asking who would be more thankful, the person who has a debt of 500 pence forgiven him or a person who has a debt of 50 pence forgiven. Jesus was saying we don’t understand how sinful we really are in the eyes of God. That is why we are not thankful like we ought to be.

I believe that is our problem today. We often deal with people who seem to not appreciate at all that God has done for them and what He has provided. Our problem as Christians, even though we are saved, is that we do not fully appreciate all that God has done for us and how rich and full and free that salvation is which He has provided.

Let’s look in Romans 3:23-25, “*For all have sinned, and come short of the glory of God; Being justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus: Whom God hath set forth to be a*

propitiation through faith in his blood, to declare His righteousness for the remission of sins that are past through the forbearance of God.” In those three verses we have summed up much of what we are going to talk about as we talk about salvation.

The central theme of the Bible is not salvation; the central theme of the Bible is the Lord Jesus Christ. In every word, from Genesis to Revelation, Jesus Christ is the central theme. But just as quickly as I say the central theme is Christ, let me say that the heartbeat of the Lord Jesus Christ is the salvation of lost men and women. That’s His heartbeat! That’s His desire! That’s the reason that He came to the world. That’s the reason that the Bible reveals who Christ is, so that we can know who He is and what He has done and in turn, be able to properly relate to the Father. That’s what salvation is all about.

In this study, there are three things we want to look at. First of all, I want you to see the reason for salvation. Secondly, the remedy that’s in salvation, and then thirdly how we receive this salvation.

THE REASON FOR SALVATION

Men Are Sinners in the Eyes of God

Why do we need to be saved? In the Old Testament there are eight words that describe the problem that you and I have. In the New Testament there are twelve words to describe our problem. We are going to look at only three of them.

Our problem is very simple. It is called **sin** and it has separated us from God. Isaiah 59:1-2 tells us that our sins have separated between us and

God so that He cannot hear us, and He cannot have fellowship with us. The Bible says in Habakkuk 1:13 that God is *“of purer eyes than to behold evil, and canst not look on iniquity.”* He can have nothing to do with our sin!

Sin

The first word we will look at is the word called **sin**. Romans 3:23 says, *“For all have sinned and come short of the glory of God.”* What is this word sin all about? The word sin has the idea of an archer who draws his bow and lets loose the arrow. The arrow takes off, but it falls short of the mark. It becomes short of the goal of the target area.

I like to use the illustration of a person going to the Grand Canyon with the idea that they are going to jump over. They have prepared themselves by working out. Then they get down into a proper position and they are ready to go. They take off running as hard as they can and they jump just as far as they possibly can.

But it doesn't matter whether they can jump 50 feet or only 5 feet. It makes no difference whatsoever. Either way they are going to wind up at the bottom of the Grand Canyon because you aren't going to get across the Grand Canyon propelled by your own legs. You need something more. That's how God looks at this business of sin in our lives. Sin is when we miss the mark that God has set for us.

If you have trusted Christ as your Savior, you realize that you are a sinner. However, I do not think this has impacted our lives as it should. We have fallen short of the goal that God has set that we must meet. We are not going to get into heaven on our own because all have sinned. We have all become sinners.

Transgression

There is a second term we want to look at. It is used in I John 3:4, which also talks about this subject of sin. *“Whosoever committeth sin transgresseth also the law: for sin is the transgression of the law.”* Sin is also called in the Bible a **transgression**. Sin is transgressing the law. It has the picture of God marking off certain boundaries for us and telling us to stay within those boundaries. But we have willingly stepped over that line. We have transgressed the boundaries that God has set in our lives.

If we were to take just the simple Ten Commandments in the Old Testament, we couldn't get past the first one without finding we have violated them. We are guilty in God's eyes; we have transgressed His law. God has set the boundaries and we have chosen to overstep those boundaries in our lives. That is a willful choice we have made.

Iniquity

The third word is found several times in the Old and New Testaments, but let's go to Isaiah 53:6. *“All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned every one to his own way; and the Lord hath laid on Him the iniquity of us all.”* The term for sin that God uses here is **iniquity**. The word iniquity means “gross sin.” It means a sin that is “way out.” It's a sin that talks about the crookedness of life. It talks about a person who has taken life and totally warped it out of perspective.

If you read Genesis 1-2, it talks about how God originally made man, and then from chapter 3 on we see how man warped life. This gives you a good picture of what iniquity is all about. If you just drive down the streets you'll see what iniquity is all about—the crookedness of life. If you sit in the homes of people as they talk about what they're living for

and what their purpose is in life you'll find people who have crooked ideas and a warped sense of reality. They are not interested in the things of God. They could care less about eternity, and they could care less about a relationship with God right now. They live for the here and now and their own selfish purposes. That's how God describes our problem. God says that all of us have sinned, all of us have transgressed and all of us, to a certain degree, have warped our sense of understanding of what life is all about.

The problem that we've talked about—the sin, the transgression, and the iniquity—is not just something that God says is a problem of most people in the world, but it is a problem that God says all of us have. In Romans 3:9, the Bible says, *“What then, are we better than they? No, in no wise for we have before proved both Jews and Gentiles, that they are all under sin.”* They are all under sin, whether Jew or Gentile.

This means all the people who have ever been born, all of the people who have ever lived on planet Earth, and all the people who now live on planet Earth. This also includes every one of us. We have all come under sin. Romans 3:23 says, *“All have sinned and come short of the glory of God.”* God puts every person who has ever lived in the category of sin. In Romans 1-3, God lists three classes of lost people.

The Heathen Man

First, in Romans 1, God talks about the heathen man. This is the man who knows nothing of God as he worships a tree, a rock, a sunset, a field, a bird in a tree or a cow that walks on the ground. In the eyes of God, that heathen man is guilty of sin. Someone may ask, “How could God be just and condemn a man like that?” Romans 1 explains that God has given them a certain amount of light and they have rejected that light. Therefore God will give them no further light on who Jesus Christ is.

The Righteous Man

The second man He deals with in chapter 2 is the Gentile righteous man who lives a moral life—a somewhat clean and upright life—a good life like many of your neighbors and many of the people that you and I know. They do the very best they can. But in the midst of doing the very best they can, they have condemned themselves. Even though they have written laws governing how to live, they haven't lived that way perfectly. They have not lived that way 100 % of the time. They have violated even the commands they have written for themselves. And so, God says they are guilty.

The Religious Man

In Romans 2-3, we see the Jewish man who says, *"I'm better than the heathen fellow. I'm better than the moral men who try to live a life of morals. I do better than them because I believe in the Bible and I believe in Jehovah God."* And then God says, *"Of all people, you are especially guilty before God."* In Romans 10, He tells them the problem they have is that they have tried to establish their own standards of righteousness. They have taken God's Word and literally thrown it out the window saying, "Let me rewrite my own standard so that I can fit in and be a good person."

Isn't that what we do today in our world? Isn't that true of what goes on in many of our churches? We try to set our own standards instead of obeying God's standards. Whenever we do that, we always draw God's standards down so that we can feel good about ourselves. The fact is, all are under sin. God isn't going to judge you according to the standards you set. God isn't going to judge you according to the standards of the moral man, and God isn't going to judge you according to the standards of the heathen man. God is going to judge you according to the standards of His written Word. His written Word says that you and I have sinned against Him, against a Holy and a Just God.

Men are Unrighteous in the Eyes of God

In Romans 3:10, He says, *“As it is written, There is none righteous, no, not one.”* The word righteous very simply means to be right in the eyes of God. The Bible says there is none righteous, no not one. God is saying that all people are unrighteous. It doesn’t matter who you are, where you live or what family you grow up with. You are unrighteous in God’s eyes. Whether you are a preacher of the gospel or a person who sits in the pew, it makes no difference. You are unrighteous in the eyes of God. Whether you happen to be a man of the cloth and turn your collar around backwards or happen to be a person who lives in the red light districts of New York City, it makes no difference. You are unrighteous in the eyes of God. That’s how God looks on you.

Men Have No Understanding

In verse 11, God says, *“There is none that understandeth, there is none that seeketh after God.”* He says that everyone is without understanding. Not only are men unrighteous sinners in the eyes of God but men don’t understand. As we talk to people about Christ some say, “I don’t know if I agree with that,” and others say, “I don’t understand.” But it’s not their head that needs to be penetrated, it’s their heart. Their heart must be changed. We must depend upon the power of the Spirit of God to work in a person’s life. God says they are without understanding. A man outside of Jesus Christ is without understanding, and all people fall under that condemnation. All people are without understanding until they come to Jesus Christ.

If you are a Christian, you have a testimony of being born again. There was a time when you were without understanding. There was a time when you were unrighteous. There was a time when you were classed in God’s eyes as a sinner before Him. If you believe there was never a time in your life like that, then you are not a child of God. A child of God who has been born again understands that there was a time when they were condemned by God.

All the World is Guilty

There is a fourth thing here that we want to make note of in Romans 3:19. He says there, *“Now we know that what things soever the law saith, it saith to them who are under the law: that every mouth may be stopped, and all the world may become guilty before God.”* The Bible says that all the world is guilty.

There are four things God tells us about every single person on planet earth. Number one, all have sinned. Number two, all are unrighteous, or not right in the eyes of God. Number three, all are without understanding. They don't understand their sin, and they don't understand the Savior, and they don't understand salvation. Number four, all are guilty in the eyes of God. This is the reason that salvation is necessary. Everyone is a sinner. Everyone needs some way to get their sin washed away. They are going to die and go out into eternity with that sin in their life, if they don't get washed. They will not be able to stand before God.

GOD'S REMEDY OF SALVATION

What is this remedy for salvation which God has provided? If every person is a sinner, what is God's remedy for that? How does God take care of this problem? Because of the sin of man, God the Father sent Jesus Christ, His Son, into the world to pay for our sins. Our salvation is not in a plan, our salvation is not in a church, our salvation is not in a ritual, our salvation is in a person: the person of **Jesus Christ**.

Christ Is Our Substitute

I want to give you four basic words that describe our salvation and give you a picture of what our salvation is all about. The first word is a word that is not found in our Bible, but the concept is there. It is an accurate description of what our salvation is all about. That is the word **substitution**.

In Isaiah 53:4 we read, *“Surely He hath borne our griefs, and carried our sorrows: yet we did esteem Him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted.”* Verse 4 is telling us that Jesus took our grief. He took our sorrows, but God was the one that struck Him, or put upon Him these problems.

In verse 5, *“He was wounded for our transgressions.”* In other words, He was our substitute. It says, *“He was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon Him; and with His stripes we are healed. All we like sheep have gone astray; we have turned everyone to his own way; and the Lord hath laid on Him the iniquity of us all.”*

Jesus Christ has switched places with us, and has become our substitute. In II Corinthians 5:21 it says, *“For He hath made Him to be sin for us, who knew no sin; that we might be made the righteousness of God in Him.”* The Bible tells us here in II Corinthians 5 the same thing that it says in Isaiah 53. It is saying that Jesus Christ—who is righteous and holy in the eyes of the Father—never had a sin in His life and came over to stand in our place. Even though we were sinners and guilty and unrighteous in the eyes of God, He stood in our place that we might come over and take His place. He took our punishment so we might take His righteousness and His blessedness. In other words, He took our place. We traded places with the Lord Jesus Christ. Salvation is substitution. That’s what it’s all about. When a person trusts Christ as his Savior they are literally saying, “Lord, I accept your substitution for me. Thank you that you sent Jesus to take my place, for I deserve to go to Hell and that’s where I would be. Thank you, Father, that you’ve sent Christ to go to Hell for me, to pay for the penalty of my sin.”

Christ Is Our Propitiation

This is a big word but what a powerful truth it teaches. In Romans 3:25, talking about Christ, the Bible says, *“Whom God hath set forth to be a propitiation through faith in His blood, to declare His righteousness for*

the remission of sins that are past, through the forbearance of God.” We find the word **propitiation** here, and we also find it in the book of I John and then several times in the Old Testament. As we come to these verses in the New Testament, we need to understand where the word came from in the Old Testament and how was it used there.

The word propitiation means “covering” or “to turn away wrath.” It is the same word in the Old Testament called atonement. Leviticus 16 tells of the mercy seat. Inside the tabernacle or in the temple, (the tabernacle was a tent where they offered the sacrifices, but the temple was built later and it was a building) there were two rooms, the Holy Place and the Most Holy Place. The high priest was the only one allowed to enter the Most Holy Place and he entered there only one time a year. There were no lights, and no way to see around, so he had to enter in by faith.

As the high priest entered in, he always entered with blood. In the Most Holy Place, also called the Holy of Holies, there was a mercy seat and carvings of two cherubims (angel-like beings) that hovered over this mercy seat. Inside the mercy seat were the broken tablets of the law. These were there indicating the Ten Commandments that God expects us to keep. Since we can’t keep the Ten Commandments, they are broken. We have broken them in our lives.

The high priest entered once a year with the blood, and sprinkled the blood on top of the mercy seat and the tablets of stone. He was thereby giving the idea of propitiation, of covering the law that has been broken. Man deserves to go to Hell, but God has graciously sent His Son Jesus to die, that His blood might be shed to cover that broken law. Not only did Jesus Christ take our place, but He covered the law which we had broken. He turned away the wrath of God.

Here is another picture of propitiation. In Exodus 12, as the Israelites were getting ready to leave Egypt, God told them they needed to kill a lamb and catch the blood. They were to take the blood and go to the door of the house. On the two door posts and on the lintel (the top post of the door) they were to place the blood.

That night as the death angel passed through the land, when he saw the blood, he would “pass over” that house. The blood literally turned away the wrath of God. If the blood was not applied, the death angel would march in and the firstborn of the house would die. So the father placed the blood, the death angel came, saw the blood and passed over that house.

That is literally what happens when Jesus Christ becomes our Savior. God’s wrath is turned away from us. We are covered by the blood of Christ. The law, which we have broken, has been covered. Jesus Christ has not only taken our place, but Jesus Christ has covered our sin. He has cared for it and has turned away the wrath of God in our life.

Christ Is Our Redemption

There is a third word also found in the Bible. Look at Romans 3:24, *“Being justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus.”* There is the word, **redemption**, which is in Christ Jesus.

We talked about substitution and Jesus taking our place. We’ve talked about propitiation, which is a covering or turning away the wrath of God. Now we look at redemption in I Peter 1:18. The Bible says, *“For as much as ye know that ye were not redeemed with corruptible things, as silver and gold, from your vain conversation received by tradition from your fathers; but with the precious blood of Christ as of a lamb without blemish and without spot.”* The Bible says that Jesus Christ has redeemed

us. We were not redeemed with corruptible or non-eternal things. We were redeemed with the incorruptible and eternal blood of Jesus Christ.

What does the word redeemed mean? It means “to buy back.” Follow with me as I give you the Old Testament setting for this word. There are several picture words that could be used when we talk about redemption, but there is one that I like the best.

Picture a Jewish man in the Old Testament who buys and buys and gets himself into a place where he can’t afford to live. He has to go on credit or borrow in order to live. In those days the only way you get your money paid back was not to file bankruptcy. It was to give your life to the person to whom you owe the money. They wouldn’t kill you, but they would take you as a slave. You would become their slave until the year of jubilee. The year of jubilee was every fifty years. If you happened to become a slave the first year, you had to wait another forty-nine years to be set free. You can imagine if you are thirty, forty, or fifty years of age already and you become a slave at that point, you are going to be eighty, ninety, or one hundred years old before you get set free. You may never get free. That is a very real possibility.

But, God also made a provision. If you were sold into slavery because you couldn’t pay your debt, and you had a near family member who had the ability to pay your debt for you, they could come and buy you back. They could redeem you. They could pay the debt for you, and buy you back and set you free.

Do you see the picture of salvation here? You and I have sold ourselves into the debt of sin. We owe a debt to God that we could never begin to pay if we would work for the rest of our lives. We could start from this day forward and live a perfect life and still not be able to pay the debt to God for our past sins because God requires perfection of us. If you start

right now and live perfectly for the rest of your days and never sin again, God would say, “Who is going to pay for those sins before you began to live perfectly?”

We understand, of course, that there is no way we could live from now through the age of sixty or seventy and never sin again. We are still sinners. But if we could do that we’d still have the sins to pay for that started in the first part of our lives. Jesus Christ came into the world to be our Redeemer. He came into the world to buy us back. He came into the world to take the debt we owe to God but we can’t pay.

We deserve to be taken by God and thrown into Hell and left there for all eternity. But Jesus Christ came into the world so He could take on human flesh and become a “near kinsman,” a family member. A human being, yet God in the flesh, to live in this life perfect before God, never sin and then offer His life to buy us back from the sin debt. Redemption is the third word that is used to talk about our salvation.

Christ Is Our Reconciliation

In II Corinthians 5:18, we find the fourth word, **reconciliation**. *“And all things are of God, who hath reconciled us to Himself by Jesus Christ, and hath given to us the ministry of reconciliation; To wit, that God was in Christ, reconciling the world unto Himself, not imputing their trespasses unto them; and hath committed unto us the word of reconciliation.”* God has reconciled us through Jesus Christ. He has brought us back together. The teaching of the Word of God is very simply that our sins have made a separation between God and us so that God cannot hear, and we cannot get to God. (Isaiah 59:1-2)

Suppose you get at odds with someone. Both of you do wrong and stand there with your backs turned to each other. If you are going to reconcile,

one of you must turn around and then get the other person to turn around. That's how you get reconciliation taking place in human terms. But when you are dealing with God, God is not the one that has turned His back. God has never turned His back. God is the one who has been perfectly holy and perfectly just. He laid out the rules and said, "This is what I accept." He has never flinched; He has never moved; He has never changed. Yet man, looking at what God has required, has turned his back on God and walked away. *"There is none that seeketh after God,"* Romans 3 says. Jesus Christ has come into the world to turn us back around so that we can be brought back together with the Father.

I think that of the four terms that we have talked about, the one that excites me the most is reconciliation. The fact that I, as a person living in this world, can be reconciled to God the Father. That means that right now, not just "pie in the sky religion, someday when I die I go to heaven," but right now I can talk with the Father. I can have fellowship with the Father, even now He is listening to me. That means something to me. So, my friend, when we talk about this business of salvation, it's a deep subject. We could talk about many of the other terms in the Bible but I think these four sum it up the best of any four terms we could pick out of the Word of God.

OUR RECEPTION OF SALVATION

Let's ask a question: "Okay, if the reason that salvation had to be provided is because we are sinners, and if the remedy in salvation is what Christ has done for us, then how in the world do we receive this salvation?" And the answer is simple. I John 5:12 informs us that *"He that hath the Son hath life; and he that hath not the Son of God hath not life."*

There are those today who believe that somehow they can be saved and not know Jesus Christ. But do you see that if you don't know Jesus Christ you can't have substitution? If you don't know Jesus Christ you can't have redemption. If you don't know Jesus Christ you can not have propitiation. If you do not know Jesus Christ you do not have reconciliation. Jesus Christ is intricately involved in all four of those terms. Without Him you don't have those four things, they don't exist. So in order to be saved and rightly related with God, you must know Jesus Christ.

How do we get this salvation? We've got to come on God's terms, first of all. Ephesians 2:8-9 tells us, *"For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God: Not of works, lest any man should boast."* In John 10:28 the Bible says, *"I give unto them eternal life."*

In Galatians 2:16 the Bible says *"Knowing that a man is not justified by the works of the law, but by the faith of Jesus Christ, even we have believed in Jesus Christ, that we might be justified by the faith of Christ, and not by the works of the law: for by the works of the law shall no flesh be justified."*

Salvation Is Free

The mistake that most people make is trying to earn God's favor. They try to do things to please God so that God will accept them and they will be saved. But here is the miracle in salvation. Salvation, my friend, is not something that you do to please God, because you are a reprobate in God's eyes. Salvation is not something that you somehow earn a part of and God provides the rest, because God cannot accept anything that you do. *"The plowing of the wicked is sin."*

Salvation is something that God gives to you even though you don't deserve it. It's a free gift. Now, when I say "free," some people think of the word "cheap." Salvation is not cheap. Salvation is free to you and I, but it is not free to God the Father. It cost him his only begotten Son.

Salvation Is By Grace

In Ephesians 2:8 we read *"For by grace are ye saved, through faith..."* Or in other words, God has given us salvation which is free to us, but it is by God's grace.

What is grace? I like to define it with an acrostic: **God's Riches At Christ's Expense**. The only way that we could get the riches that God has to offer us was if Christ paid for us to have them. The only way that we could have our sins covered was if Christ died so that His blood could cover them. The only way we could be bought back was if Christ died to buy us back. The only way that we could be substituted for was if Christ would take our place. And the only way, my friend, that our lives in any way could be brought back, reconciled to God, was if Christ came to be that Reconciler. So we say grace is what it cost God. Another way to define grace is "God's unmerited love." In other words it is love that God gives that we did not merit, and we did not earn. Nothing we could do would make God pleased with us. It is simply that God chose to love us anyway, just the way we are.

Salvation Is Through Faith

Then, third of all, it's through faith. *"For by grace are ye saved through faith."* (Ephesians 2:8) And here I want to give you five words.

We Must Believe

John 3:16 says, *“For God so loved the world, that He gave His only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in Him should not perish, but have everlasting life.”* How do you not perish but have everlasting life? It is he that **believeth**. A man must believe. When we talk about believing in the Bible, it is more than just an intellectual understanding, but it is an understanding none the less. There needs to be an understanding that we are sinners and we don’t deserve God’s love or God’s favor. We need to understand that Jesus Christ came, and died on the cross in our place.

We need to understand that He rose again from the dead. He really is God in the flesh. If we reject this book and we reject the revelation of God and we turn our back on it, there is no way that we can be saved. Romans 10:17 says, *“Faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the Word of God.”* So we must believe what God has said about the person of Jesus Christ.

We Must Trust

But this believing goes deeper than just believing the Bible. It goes to the word **trusting** found in Ephesians 1:12, *“That we should be to the praise of His glory, who first trusted in Christ.”* The idea of believing also incorporates the idea of trusting. Not only must we believe in Christ, but we must trust in Him as well. To trust in Christ is to put our full weight in His hands. It is saying, “Lord, if you don’t save me, I have nothing else to count on, nothing else to trust in, nothing else to hope in, nowhere else to turn. It is either what Christ has done that gets me to heaven, or I have nothing to recommend myself to God at all.”

Do you see the difference between true salvation and many people’s religion? There are many who say they believe in Jesus Christ, but they have not trusted in Him alone. They are trusting in Him plus baptism, or Him plus church membership. That’s not salvation.

We Must Receive

We read in I John 5:12, “*He that hath the Son hath life; and he that hath not the Son of God hath not life.*” The only way we can be born again is if we have believed in Him, trusted in Him and **received** Him because He is salvation. It’s not that we get the gift of salvation and then somewhere later find Christ. It is when we find Christ, we have gotten the whole package.

In John 1:11 it says, “*He came unto His own, and His own received Him not. But as many as received Him, to them gave He power to become the sons of God, even to them that believe on His name.*” We must receive Christ into our life. There are those who will not receive Him, and they push Him away at arm’s length. But we must receive Him into our life. That’s the method of God’s salvation.

We Must Commit

The last two words are found in Romans 10:9-10. “*That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised Him from the dead, thou shalt be saved. For with the heart man believeth unto righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made unto salvation.*”

The word here is **commit**. Verse 9 says, “*That if thou shalt confess with thy mouth the **Lord** Jesus.*” You’ll never find anywhere in the Bible where it talks about salvation and it talks about Christ as the Savior only. It always talks about Him as the **Lord** Jesus Christ. In other words, when you come to Christ for salvation, you don’t come to Him saying you need a fire escape out of Hell so that you won’t burn forever, but you want to go do your own thing. He won’t take you like that.

He wants you to come to Him and say, “Lord, you are Lord and I’ll bow to whatever you say in these Scriptures for salvation, whatever you say

in my life, it goes.” It’s true, we may backslide later. In fact I’ll guarantee you, somewhere along the line to some degree every Christian is going to backslide (unless you happen to die the moment you get saved).

But when you got saved, you were fully surrendered to God, as fully surrendered as you could be at that moment. That is what salvation is all about. “I’m committed.” If there is anything that can turn you away from receiving Christ at the time when the Spirit of God is dealing with your heart, if there is anything that can make you turn your back and walk away from Christ, then you are not ready to get saved.

I’ve seen people I have tried to talk out of getting saved because I didn’t think they were sincere. But they were sincere. They got saved in spite of me. If the Spirit of God deals with somebody and they really mean business, they are going to settle it with the Lord.

We Must Call

The next word is **call**. Here is one that many people misunderstand. Verse 13 says, *“For whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord shall be saved.”* I talk to people all the time who tell me, “Preacher, I believe in Jesus, and I’ve always believed in Jesus. I’ve been religious.” I ask, “Has there ever been a time and a place when you have called on the name of the Lord Jesus Christ?” They say, “No, I don’t think so, I don’t remember that. I just believe in Him, isn’t that enough?”

And the answer is “No!” It’s whosoever shall call upon the name of the Lord. That is prayer. It doesn’t necessarily have to be an “out loud” prayer. It can be a prayer in your heart. Nevertheless, it must be a prayer. It must be a conscious request to God for Jesus Christ to come into your life to save you and to forgive your sins. It must be a conscience prayer such as, “Lord, I want to trust Christ as my Savior and Lord.”

CONCLUSION

Friend, when you are born again you'll never forget it. Some may say they just don't remember anything like that happening in their life. If I didn't remember it, I'd surely get it settled. What I am saying to you is that salvation is real. Jesus Christ has provided it. Salvation isn't wrapped up in a church; salvation is wrapped up in a Person. You need to know Him. What a great salvation He has provided! Don't miss it because you are hanging onto a church or baptism or some family background. As the songwriter says,

*“Turn your eyes upon Jesus,
Look full in His wonderful face.
And the things of earth will grow strangely dim
In the light of His glory and grace.”*
--Helen Howarth Lemmel

QUESTIONS ON SALVATION

1. According to Romans 3:23, who is a sinner?
2. What is the central theme of the Bible?
3. What has separated man from God?
4. Give a definition of sin.
5. Why is a heathen man guilty before God?
6. Why is the righteous man condemned?
7. Why is the religious man condemned?
8. What four things are true of every person?
 - a.
 - b.
 - c.
 - d.

9. What four things has Christ done for us?

a.

b.

c.

d.

10. What is grace?

11. What are the steps taken for a person to come to salvation?